

SANTOS ECHEVARRIA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Automotive finance leader with 33+ years running F&I operations at South Florida franchise dealerships, including 28 years with a single Nissan store. Owns the full finance function end to end: deal structuring and funding, F&I product strategy and menu presentation, lender portfolio management, and regulatory compliance. Built the finance discipline of a 15-person sales floor through hands-on training on deal structure, compliance, and customer hand-off. Six-time Nissan Award of Excellence winner and a two-decade Platinum performer in Nissan Security Plus products. Seeking an F&I Director role where department-level ownership, lender relationships, and a spotless compliance record drive dealership gross.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Finance Manager — Bill Seidle Nissan Auto Group

1998 – Present

Ran the finance office for a 15-person sales operation

- Owned the F&I function for a high-volume Nissan store across three decades of market cycles, lender-appetite shifts, and DMS platform changes.
- Set and executed F&I product strategy — extended warranties, GAP, service contracts — sustaining product penetration and PVR at levels recognized annually by the manufacturer.
- Managed the dealership's lender portfolio: cultivated and maintained relationships across multiple banks, captives, and credit unions to hold approval rates and buy rates across the full credit spectrum, from prime through subprime.
- Owned compliance for the department — Truth in Lending, the Fair Credit Reporting Act, Red Flags Rule, OFAC — across thousands of funded deals with a clean record.
- Built the sales floor's finance capability: trained and mentored sales staff on deal structure, disclosure requirements, and finance-office hand-off, protecting both CSI and gross.
- Ran daily operations in CDK, DealerTrack, and Reynolds & Reynolds — deal files, credit submission, contract processing, and funding follow-up.

Finance Manager — Brickell Honda

1990 – 1998

- Ran the F&I process for retail vehicle sales, structuring deals that held dealership gross while staying inside customer affordability.
- Built the bank and credit-union network that carried approvals for a broad and credit-diverse Miami customer base.
- Sold and administered aftermarket F&I products, driving monthly penetration and departmental gross profit.
- Held documentation and disclosure standards across every deal in the store.

LEADERSHIP & DEPARTMENT SKILLS

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| • F&I Department Operations & Menu Strategy | • DMS Operations — CDK, DealerTrack, Reynolds |
| • Lender Portfolio & Buy-Rate Management | • Team Leadership & Mentoring (teams of 15+) |
| • Compliance Ownership (TILA, FCRA, Red Flags, OFAC) | • Customer Retention & CSI Protection |
| • Sales-Floor Training & Finance Hand-Off | • Prime Through Subprime Deal Structuring |

NOTABLE ACHIEVEMENTS & AWARDS

- Nissan Award of Excellence — 6-Time Winner
- Nissan Security Plus Products, Platinum Level — Awarded Annually (2005–2025)
- 28-year tenure at a single Nissan dealership